accusations such as well-poisoning made against the Jews were false. Contemporary Europeans can easily verify that what they choose to believe—that Israel is conducting a war of extermination against the Palestinians—is utterly wrong.

THE PROTECTIVE EDGE CAMPAIGN

Similarly, Israel's Protective Edge Campaign of summer 2014 can be used as a prism. By attempting to analyze the major global reactions, one obtains a panoramic view on a number of issues within the Western world and in particular, Europe. One major phenomenon was the outburst of antisemitism in many countries. Muslims played a major role in many of the most severe incidents. As far as semantics are concerned, several messages and expressions were frequently heard from politicians. One of these was that one should not import the Palestinian-Israeli conflict into Western countries.[24] Yet this conflict had been imported years ago by the massive, non-selective influx of immigrants from dictatorial Muslim countries where antisemitism is rife.

Another expression spoken off by authorities concerned "the tension between communities". This was a euphemism for Muslim aggression against Jews. In the Netherlands, the CJO, the umbrella organization of the Jewish community, even signed a joint declaration with the Dutch government using this false terminology.

An issue which came to the fore was the extreme power of emotional propaganda, and in particular, that of sentimental appeals. This fallacy is primarily based on feelings of pity and support for the poor and weak, in this case the Palestinians.[25]

Henry Silverman defines this fallacy of appealing to pity as consisting "of emotionally-charged images or language intended to evoke sympathy and manipulate an audience into adopting a partisan view or supporting an interest group."[26] This is precisely what happened. The Palestinians have become super-victims and often can do no wrong in the eyes of many of their Western supporters.[27] Many Western reactions to the Protective Edge campaign have borne this out.

COMPLEMENTARY PRISMS

Using a combination of complementary prisms increases their effectiveness. One such complementary prism to Israel and Jews is Hamas. One can use Hamas to analyze the positions of various organizations and individuals, who express themselves on the Palestinian-Israeli conflict, and see what they say

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,